

12.4 Closing Files

Although you can open multiple files, there's a limit to how many you can have open at once. If your program will open many files in succession, you'll want to close each one as you're done with it; otherwise the standard I/O library could run out of the resources it uses to keep track of open files. Closing a file simply involves calling `fclose` with the file pointer as its argument:

```
fclose(fp);
```

Calling `fclose` arranges that (if the file was open for output) any last, buffered output is finally written to the file, and that those resources used by the operating system (and the C library) for this file are released. If you forget to close a file, it will be closed automatically when the program exits.

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